

Board that voted against Twenty20 and it was outvoted out 9-1... Now we are just encashing on it," he says.

This encashment is in danger of obliterating the traditional game. The plan to add two new IPL teams in 2011 and increase matches from 60 to 90 seems like composing a funeral requiem for Test cricket. BCCI Secretary N. Srinivasan, also a franchise owner of the Chennai Super Kings, is adamant that no decision has been made on the number of teams.

Manohar, who for his part steers clear of Twenty20, says that the BCCI

cricket aside, there is a fierce tug of war between the ICC and its key members and India is keenly involved.

ICC CEO Haroon Lorgat said that despite the criticism the BCCI faced about its Test calendar, it was "well aware of its responsibilities..." As No.1 side, the BCCI could "also take into account the mood in the country, particularly with some of its top players asking for more Tests so that they could defend their well-earned status after years of hard work and performance." In another age, that would have counted as the declaration of a duel.

discussed." In response to that statement, Srinivasan, one of the members of the CEC, said, "The committee is yet to meet and discuss, so I think Lorgat's view is possibly his own."

Any Test championship final will turn into an ICC event, an idea that leaves the BCCI unimpressed. Manohar said, "We will have to see whether it is advisable to play ICC events that are held every year. It is a problem for all nations." He wants four-year gaps between ICC's main events. "So the ICC only has one event once in two years. The ICC could feel



“One of the proposals of the ICC's CEO committee is to develop a Test championship final.”

HAROON LORGAT, CEO, ICC

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N. SRINIVASAN, SECRETARY, BCCI

had made it compulsory for anyone dreaming of the IPL to play a healthy quantity of domestic cricket in the 80 days it was available.

For now, according to Srinivasan, the BCCI would try to work out new bilateral arrangements to increase India's Tests in the next two years by the time the current FTP comes to an end in 2012. A draft of the next round of the FTP had been agreed upon and could be released as early as February.

Despite these plans, Test cricket itself is in a state of great churning. Cordial meetings and soothing statements about the primacy of Test

The point of dispute now centres around how Test cricket's territory is to be reshaped. Lorgat said that a Chief Executive's Committee (CEC) had been recently formed, "to develop a meaningful context for Test cricket and suggest how we can promote Tests to be more interesting".

That context itself now seems to be in dispute. Lorgat added, "One of the proposals under consideration is to develop some form of championship final while a number of other possible enhancements for Test cricket, including the idea of day-night Tests, rebranding the concept of Test cricket... are being

though that if that happens, its revenues will be reduced." The ICC's basket of events has increased from a single 50-over World Cup to the Champions Trophy and now the World T20. Between 2010 and 2015, it will have an event every year.

Already, comments by ICC chief David Morgan about the new FTP doing away with home and away series have been met with scorn within the BCCI. But in an administrative arm-wrestling contest, all scorn is met with a counter-sneer. What India can do without though is its Test team being mocked for not playing enough. ■